

OTESSA 2025 Online Conference Program

May 22, 2025 @ 10:14 am PDT (UTC-07:00)

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Welcome



Figure 1: OTESSA Logo

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

! Important

Check the [OTESSA conference website for abstracts](#) and any changes to this program. Information about any changes to the program will also be available via the OTESSA Welcome Desk on the conference platform once the conference opens.

All OTESSA Participants can attend the [Congress “Big Thinking” lecture series](#). These take place each day of the conference. Congress has “[open events](#)” available as well (open to registrants across association conferences at Congress as well as those who hold community passes).

All OTESSA Registrants can also attend conference sessions offered by the [Canadian Association for the Study of Education \(CSSE\)](#), [Canadian Association for the Study of Higher Education \(CSSHE\)](#), and [Canadian Association of Learned Journals \(CALJ\)](#) as we have reciprocity agreements in place. Please note that presenters must register in each conference in which they are presenting.

Monday, June 2

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

Victoria, BC

Santa Fe, NM

Toronto, ON

8:30 - 9:00 | Conference Welcome, Announcements, & Land Acknowledgement

Location

9:00 - 10:00 | Keynote: Thomas Reeves

Location

10:00 - 10:15 | Break

10:15 - 11:15 | Concurrent Session 1 | Advancing Digital Education and AI-Infused Pedagogies

(60 Mins)

Session 1A

Location

10:15 - 10:35 | Creating Capacity for Digital Transformation

Research

Macfadyen et al. | *Affiliation*

Abstract

Globally, the demand for online education has surged, driven by the need for flexible and accessible learning (Johnson, 2023; Quality Matters, 2023) and dramatically escalated by the COVID-19 pandemic (Cui et al. 2022). In 2024, Cui et al. noted that doctoral level education in educational technology will “build critical capacity for leading research and driving transformation in policy and practice”. In this study we contend that while doctoral-level expertise and leadership is vital, it is widespread access to flexible post-graduate education and training for current and upcoming educators and practitioners that will support system-wide upskilling for ongoing digital transformation. In 2019, and in 2024, we surveyed the global landscape of masters-level education related to educational technologies and digital learning. Currently, 39 institutions offer 65 master’s degree programs in this field. Surprisingly, only eight new master’s degree programs in educational technology launched globally, post-pandemic. However, we did discover extensive curricular rebalancing. Here, we report on the current state of master’s level education in educational technology, curricular expansions in topic areas that including management, planning and leadership, research methods, technical aspects of design, data and analytics, emerging issues & technologies, and instructional strategies, and we consider how these reflect current educational needs.

10:35 - 10:55 | Cultivating GenAI Literacy – Moving Past AI Pedagogy’s Hype

Research

Nguyen | *Affiliation*

Abstract

In this session, I examine the relationship between GenAI and pedagogy in higher education, challenging the notion of AI pedagogy while advocating for critical and mindful integration of AI tools within existing pedagogical frameworks. Drawing on the recent literature on digital pedagogies and practical experiences, I argue that while AI tools can enhance educational outcomes, they cannot replace the fundamental human elements that define true pedagogy, including empathy, ethical reasoning, critical thinking, and creativity. This session aims to contribute to the ongoing dialogue about the role of AI in higher education by proposing a practical framework for cultivating AI literacy

among educators while maintaining the essential human-centered approach to teaching and learning.

10:55 - 11:15 | Forthcoming

Track

Author | Affiliation

i Abstract

Session 1B

Location

10:15 - 11:15 | Assessment for Equity: Openness and DEI in your grading architecture (WorkShop)

Workshop

Colin Madland & Jess Mitchell | University of Victoria & Ontario College of Art and Design University

i Abstract

This workshop will provide an overview of how you can use your grading architecture (how you lead learners through activities that support their learning, and ultimately, how you arrive at a final grade) to support greater equity using openness and DEI in your assessment practice. Equity is compromised when grades are assigned based on anything other than what a learner knows or can do (e.g., arbitrary due dates, punitive policies, etc.). Openness is compromised when learners, instructors, or other stakeholders do not fully understand the meaning and implications of the grades that are assigned. Bring your syllabus and join us as we explore ways to build assessment architectures that ensure grades are assigned according to what learners know and that learners understand how to progress in their learning journey based on the feedback you provide. We will discuss the purposes of assessment, sources of inequity in grading and how to overcome them, effective communication of feedback, instructor workload, and resources to assist you in your journey into alt-grading practices that meet you where you are.

11:15 - 11:45 | Break

11:45 - 12:45 | Concurrent Session 2

(60 Mins)

Session 2A | Bridging Digital Divides: From Rural Parental Perspectives to Competency-Based Digital Teaching

Location

11:45 - 12:05 | Social Representations of Parents from Rural Areas Regarding Access and Use of Digital Technology

Research

Gauthier | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

From the very beginning of the COVID-19 pandemic, digital technologies proved to be essential for the functioning of society (INSPQ, 2021). However, behind the apparent “hyperconnectivity” of young people, they are not exempt from digital inequalities (CEFRIQ, 2017), and most importantly, they are not innate experts in these technologies (Yagoubi, 2020). Moreover, parents are the closest authority figures to young people regarding the “virtual world” (Reginasari et al., 2021). On the other hand, they may experience a certain ambivalence towards digital technology. Using the conceptual framework of social representations (Moscovici, 1961, 1976), this qualitative research, originating from a master’s thesis in social work, analyzes the discourse of 10 parents living in rural areas of Saguenay-Lac-Saint-Jean during the COVID-19 pandemic. The results indicate that they acquired knowledge of videoconferencing, which allowed them to continue their daily lives and ensure their children’s education. Some were able to develop a more positive attitude towards technology, while others experienced exhaustion or fatigue related to digital usage. Additionally, parents have a techno-deterministic view of digital technology and remain under the impression that young people have abilities they themselves do not possess (the “digital native” myth). This study can help professionals better understand the digital issues faced by parents and integrate them into their practice, whether in social work or the educational field.

12:05 - 12:25 | Digital Learning for Innovative Teaching: Adopting a Competency-Based Approach

Practice

Elias | *Affiliation*

Abstract

“The Digital Learning Competency Framework developed at Vancouver Community College organizes 21 discrete competencies into three categories and seven sub-categories. Together, these competencies delineate essential digital knowledge, skills and attitudes for instructors and other learning practitioners. Each competency is further defined at four levels of proficiency so that all learning practitioners, regardless of their starting point, can easily engage in meaningful and applied learning paths aligned with their specific needs. These competencies are now being used to develop a Digital Learning For Innovative Teaching (DLIT) microcredential that will offer formal, for credit online learning opportunities with recognition via digital badges and a short certificate. There is also future potential for the Digital Learning Competency Framework, and an associated open challenge bank, to be used to develop and recognize less formal digital learning professional development via portfolio assessment, workshops and other formats. This session discusses the Digital Learning Competency Framework development process, its current uses and the potential to extend its use over time.

Session 2B

Location

11:45 - 12:45 | Designing Assessment As, Of, and For Learning with GenAI tools (Workshop)

Workshop

Nguyen | *Affiliation*

Abstract

When discussing assessment, we often focus primarily on assessment of learning (summative) and assessment for learning (formative). In this interactive session, we will explore how GenAI tools can be integrated across the full spectrum of assessment practice: as, of, and for learning. The session will start with a discussion on the theoretical foundations of different types of assessment and their intersection with GenAI tools, followed by

practical demonstrations of how GenAI tools can enhance assessment strategies. Participants will actively engage in designing multi-layered assessment activities that promote student engagement and autonomy, utilizing GenAI in an ethical and meaningful way.

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

12:45 - 1:00 | Break

1:00- 2:30 | Networking

Tuesday, June 3

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

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Toronto, ON

10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | James Slotta - Future of Ed Tech

11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Concurrent Session 3

(60 mins)

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

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Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 4

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

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Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

1:30 - 2:30 | Concurrent Session 5

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Wednesday, June 4

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11:00 - 11:15 | Break

11:15 - 12:15 | Keynote | Laura Czerniewicz, Catherine Cronin, Helen Beetham

12:15 - 12:45 | Break

12:45 - 1:45 | Concurrent Session 6

(60 mins)

1:45 - 2:00 | Break

2:00 - 3:00 | Concurrent Session 7

Session # | Theme

Location

Time | Title

Research

Author | *Affiliation*

i Abstract

Thursday, June 5

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

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10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Jennifer Wemigwans - Remote from Congress in Toronto

1:30 - 2:30 PDT | Keynote | George Veletsianos

Friday, June 6

Times listed in this program are Pacific Daylight Time (Victoria, BC)

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Toronto, ON

9:10 - 10:10 PDT | Presidential Address | Valerie Irvine & Stephanie Moore

//todo #1 ## 10:00 - 11:00 PDT | Keynote | Jean-Paul Restoule

1:45 - 2:05 | Publication Pathways | Michele Jacobsen & Valerie Irvine

2:05 - 2:15 | Break

2:15 - 3:15 | Victoria Concurrent

3:15 - 3:30 | Online Closing - Jon Dron